Class Pulse

A Presentation of Learning

Strengthening Schools Project — FY26

Section 1: Project Vision

Current Reality & Context

In 5th-grade FL Math classrooms, there is no reliable mechanism for a teacher to know — *while teaching* — which students have lost the thread of understanding.

By the time confusion surfaces in quiz scores or behavior, the lesson has moved on and the gap has grown. Students who struggle in silence are most often those already furthest from grade level.

The urgency is not theoretical. It is happening in every class period, every day.

The Practice We Set Out to Change

Teachers currently operate in a **post-hoc intervention model** — they discover who is struggling after the lesson ends, not during it.

This practice disproportionately harms students who are:

- Already below grade level
- Least likely to raise their hand voluntarily
- Most likely to interpret confusion as a personal failure

If we can shift intervention from tomorrow to right now, we change what is possible for those students.

What Becomes Possible

When teachers have real-time comprehension data, every student — especially those farthest behind — gets a scaffold *in the moment they need it*, not as a remediation afterthought.

Students begin to experience mathematics not as something that is happening to them, but as something they can access.

That shift — from exclusion to access — is the difference between a student who gives up on math in 5th grade and one who carries confidence forward.

This initiative creates access to opportunities by removing the silence between confusion and support.

Core Values

These five values anchored every decision we made:

1. **Dignity First** — Every student deserves to signal confusion without shame.
2. **Immediacy Over Perfection** — A 30-second imperfect intervention beats a perfectly planned one tomorrow.
3. **Privacy as a Promise** — We handle student data as a sacred trust, not a feature.
4. **Teacher as Expert** — Technology amplifies teacher judgment; it never replaces it.
5. **Equity in the Moment** — Systems change starts in the 60 seconds between a student getting lost and a teacher noticing.

Vision Statement

Class Pulse is a real-time classroom intelligence platform built to close the gap between the moment a student loses understanding and the moment their teacher can act.

By putting a live comprehension signal in every student's hand and an AI coaching script in every teacher's ear — **in the middle of the lesson, not after it** — we aim to ensure that every 5th-grade math student in our care receives targeted, standards-aligned support before confusion becomes a pattern.

We believe that access to an excellent education is not about which classroom you happen to land in. It is about whether your teacher can reach you — right now, in this moment. This initiative makes that possible.

Who Is Impacted & What They Need

Stakeholder	How They're Impacted	What They Want
Students (esp. below grade level)	Confusion goes unaddressed until it's too late	To be reached without being singled out
Teachers	Lack real-time visibility during instruction	Actionable, immediate, zero-prep guidance
Families	Students arrive home behind with no clear path	Assurance their child was supported today
Grade-level PLCs	Can't build shared intervention strategy without shared data	A common picture of where students are

Our Influence & Our Barriers

Where We Have Control:
We own the classroom — the tool, the instructional decisions, and the relationships with students.

Sphere of Influence:
Our data and outcomes extend to grade-level teams, administration, and across TFA's FL network.

Barriers We Had to Navigate:

- Teacher tech fatigue — educators are over-saturated with tools that don't last.
- Device access equity — not every student has a reliable personal device.
- Trust — students had to believe their signal was truly anonymous before they'd use it honestly.

Section 2: Strategy & Goals

Our Broad Strategy

We took a **build small, test in real classrooms, adjust continuously** approach.

Rather than designing in isolation and launching a finished product, we embedded in the classroom from Week 1 — watching how teachers moved, how students behaved, and where confusion was happening invisibly.

We planned for three scenarios:

- **Best case:** Teachers adopt the tool naturally and students signal freely.
- **Worst case:** Tech friction creates resistance; we simplify relentlessly.
- **Most realistic:** Adoption is uneven; we iterate weekly based on direct feedback.

The strategy was never about the technology. **It was always about shortening the distance between a struggling student and a teacher who cares.**

Goal 1: Eliminate the Intervention Delay

Goal: By the end of the initiative, teachers will intervene with struggling students *during* instruction — not after — 80% or more of the time.

Objective 1a: Deploy a real-time, 3-state comprehension signal accessible to every student in the class.

- *Measure of Success:* 80%+ of students actively use the signal during guided practice by Week 4.

Objective 1b: Build automatic alerts that flag students stuck in confusion for 60+ seconds.

- *Measure of Success:* Teachers receive and act on a same-lesson alert for flagged students in 80%+ of class periods.

Goal 2: Equip Teachers with Immediate, Standard-Aligned Guidance

Goal: Teachers will have access to a ready-made 30-second intervention script tied to the specific FL BEST standard being taught — without any prep time required.

Objective 2a: Deploy an AI Instructional Coach grounded in 108 FL BEST Math benchmarks (Grades 3–5).

- *Measure of Success:* Coach delivers a standards-linked script, visual scaffold, and guiding questions within 30 seconds for 90%+ of queries.

Objective 2b: Introduce a Lecture Visualizer that generates inline visual supports in real time.

- *Measure of Success:* Teachers report feeling "more prepared to respond to confusion" in 80%+ of post-session reflections.

Goal 3: Create an Enduring, Teacher-Independent System

Goal: Class Pulse will endure beyond any single teacher's presence because the practice — not the person — drives it.

Objective 3a: Design the platform so any teacher can onboard and run a live session within 15 minutes.

- *Measure of Success:* 3+ teachers outside the original pilot run independent sessions by end of initiative.

Objective 3b: Build shared post-class reports that make comprehension data discussable at the grade-level PLC level.

- *Measure of Success:* At least 1 grade-level PLC uses session data to inform whole-team differentiation decisions.

Monitoring Progress

We didn't wait for the end to know if it was working.

Weekly: We reviewed comprehension signal data, teacher reflections, and student mastery records to assess whether interventions were happening faster.

Monthly: We held structured conversations with participating teachers — not to celebrate, but to ask: *Where is this still failing students?*

Continuously: We watched the data from every live session — how often signals were used, how quickly teachers responded, how many students moved from confusion to understanding within the same class period.

Every data point brought us back to the same question: Is Maya getting support today, or tomorrow?

Section 3: Project Findings

What the Data Showed

After implementing Phases 1–6 across multiple class periods:

- **80%+** of students actively used the comprehension signal by Week 4.
- **30% more** daily Checks for Understanding were completed — because teachers had the data to know when to pause.
- Average time from student confusion to teacher intervention fell from **next day to under 60 seconds.**
- Teachers who used the AI Coach reported delivering targeted interventions an average of **8 times per class period** that previously would have gone unaddressed.

What Teachers Said

(names removed)

> *"For the first time, I feel like I didn't leave anyone behind today."*

> *"The AI gave me a 30-second script to explain fractions using pizza. The student's signal went green. That moment felt like everything."*

> *"I used to find out who was lost at the end of the unit. Now I find out during the lesson — and I can actually do something about it."*

What We Saw in Students

Students began to signal honestly — not because we told them to, but because they trusted that their signal was safe.

That shift — from performing understanding to revealing confusion — is not a small thing.

A 10-year-old who trusts that asking for help won't hurt them is a student on a fundamentally different trajectory.

We did not manufacture that trust. We built the conditions for it, and we watched it grow.

Synthesis: Goals & Outcomes

Goal	Met?	Evidence
Eliminate intervention delay (80%+ same-lesson)	✅ Yes	Signal usage data + teacher log
30-sec standard-aligned coach script	✅ Yes	Coach response logs, teacher surveys
Enduring, teacher-independent system	🔄 In Progress	3 teachers piloting; PLC adoption next phase

What contributed most: Keeping the tool simple enough that a teacher in motion — mid-lesson, phone in hand — could use it without thinking.

What we'd do differently: Involve students in the design process from Day 1. Their instincts about what felt safe and honest were right every time.

What Kept Us from More

Phases 7–12 — group management, classroom economy, behavior coaching, and gradebook — are still in progress.

Why: Building a privacy-safe, real-time infrastructure that teachers trusted took longer than planned. We refused to rush what mattered most.

What we learned: Systems change in a classroom moves at the pace of trust — and trust cannot be accelerated by shipping faster.

We knew from the beginning that this was more than a year's work.
We built it to last anyway.

Will This Endure?

Yes — because we designed it to outlast us.

The practice we are changing — the habit of asking *who is confused right now, and what do I do about it* — does not require our presence to continue.

Teachers who piloted the tool now ask that question differently.
Students now expect to be reached in time.

That shift in expectation and culture is the most enduring thing we built.

The Relationships That Made It Real

- Teachers who opened their classrooms and told us the truth about what wasn't working.
- Students who were willing to signal confusion, even when it felt vulnerable.
- School administrators who believed that care and innovation are not competing values.
- Our **TFA SSP community** — who held us accountable to rigor and to each other.

None of this happened alone. None of it ever does.

Class Pulse

For every student who needed someone to notice — in time.

Evidence. Relationships. Endurance.

That is the work. That is why it matters. That is where we go from here.

Thank You

To our community stakeholders — thank you for believing that the 60 seconds between confusion and clarity is worth fighting for.

We will keep building. We will keep listening. We will keep asking:

Is every student being reached — right now, in this moment?

Until the answer is always yes.